# PDF accessibility starter checklist

An introductory checklist for reviewing accessibility before delivering a PDF.

## Document setup

• Confirm intended language, title and meaningful metadata.

• Check tagging, heading levels, reading order, lists and section structure.

• Provide descriptive and accurate link text; ensure keyboard navigation.

## Visual and non-text content

• Provide useful alternative text for informative images; mark decorative images appropriately.

• Use actual table structures, clear headers and correct cell associations.

• Check minimum readable text size, color contrast and any instructions dependent on color.

## Forms and scanned documents

• Label form fields, set accessible names and provide comprehensible instructions and errors.

• Run OCR on scanned documents and review extracted text carefully.

• Provide accessible bookmarks or navigation for long documents when appropriate.

## Validation

• Review with a PDF accessibility checker; investigate rather than blindly accepting results.

• Test logical reading sequence and accessible labels with relevant assistive technology.

• Manual review is essential: automated checks alone cannot certify accessibility.

## Applicable standards

• Determine requirements for the audience and jurisdiction; consider WCAG, PDF/UA, Section 508, etc.

• The checklist is a starting reference, not a legal or certification assessment.

To discuss your requirements: WhatsApp +91 9773518152. Actual scope and compliance obligations require project-specific review.